

ScholarArena x IACompetitions

Founding SaaS Partner Engagement Proposal

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1. Executive Summary

ScholarArena invites IACompetitions to become its **first Founding SaaS Partner**, co-shaping the platform that will power academic competition management for K-12 organizations nationwide.

This proposal covers **Phase 1: Online Exam Module** — a four-week accelerated build delivering a production-ready qualifying exam system with full COPPA compliance. In exchange for early adoption and a multi-year SaaS commitment, IAC receives preferential pricing, direct product input, and locked SaaS rates for 24 months.

Total Engagement Investment	\$82,500 – \$97,500
Founding Partner Discount	15% off list (conditions apply)
Effective Investment Range	\$70,125 – \$82,875
SaaS Rate Lock	24 months from go-live
Delivery Window	4 calendar weeks from signed SOW

2. Engagement Context

Why This Engagement Exists

IAC currently conducts qualifying rounds through manual or fragmented tools. ScholarArena has built the tournament management, registration, and family portal layers. The missing piece — **an integrated online exam module** — is the linchpin that completes the qualifying pipeline:

Student Registers → Takes Qualifying Exam → Score Thresholds Applied
→ Qualified Students Notified → Regional Tournament Registration Opens

Building this module in partnership with IAC, rather than speculatively, eliminates wasted product investment and ensures real operational fit from day one.

IAC's Profile Requires COPPA-First Architecture

IAC's participant base spans K-8 (Elementary/Middle) and 9-12 divisions, meaning a significant percentage of test-takers are **under 13 years of age**. This triggers mandatory compliance requirements under the **Children's Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA)**. Any exam system that collects student data — even just a name and answer set — requires:

- Verifiable parental consent before data collection for students under 13
- Age verification at the point of registration
- A parental authorization portal with audit-grade consent records
- Data minimization and retention policies
- Documented breach response procedures

This is not optional. It is a legal prerequisite. This proposal treats COPPA compliance as a **first-class, separately scoped, separately priced workstream** — not a checkbox.

3. Scope of Work

Phase 1 Deliverables (4-Week Build)

3.1 Online Exam Module

Feature	Description
Exam Authoring	Admin interface to create question banks, set time limits, randomize question order per subject area (History, Science, Geography, etc.)
Exam Delivery	Secure, browser-based exam interface with countdown timer, question navigation, auto-save, and graceful timeout handling
Division Routing	Automatic routing to correct question sets based on participant division (K-8 vs 9-12, Varsity vs Junior Varsity)
Anti-Cheat Controls	Tab-switch detection, single active session enforcement, IP logging, no right-click / copy-paste on question text
Auto-Grading	Instant scoring for multiple-choice; admin review queue for free-response items
Score Thresholds	Configurable cut-scores per division/subject; automatic qualification flag generation
Results Interface	Student: personal score + pass/fail notification. Admin: exportable score roster with qualification status
Integration with Registration	Qualified students auto-populate eligibility for regional tournament registration

3.2 Parent Portal — Exam Management Extensions

Feature	Description
Exam Authorization	Parent approves child sitting an exam (COPPA flow — see Section 4)
Result Visibility	Parent dashboard shows child's exam result, score, and qualification status
Consent Receipt	Printable/downloadable PDF consent record linked to each exam session

3.3 Admin Exam Dashboard

Feature	Description
Exam Configuration	Create/edit/publish exams; set open and close windows; manage question banks
Monitoring	Live view of active sessions (count, progress, flagged sessions)
Results Management	Review free-response queue; override scores with audit note; export full results to CSV
COPPA Audit Report	Pull consent records by exam, date range, or student; required for regulatory response

3.4 Student Exam Portal

Feature	Description
Exam Lobby	Student sees available exams, status (available / locked / completed), and countdown to open window
Exam Interface	Clean, distraction-reduced interface with progress indicator and timer
Post-Exam	Immediate result (pass/fail + score) upon submission; blocked from re-entry

Out of Scope — Phase 1

The following are explicitly **not** included in this engagement and may be addressed in future phases:

- Live proctoring or video surveillance integrations
- Free-response AI grading
- Mobile native applications (iOS/Android)
- SSO / third-party identity federation (e.g., Clever, ClassLink)
- Payment processing for exam fees
- Buzzer system integrations
- Historical data migration from prior exam systems

4. COPPA Compliance Workstream

This workstream is scoped, priced, and delivered **independently** of the core exam module. It can be purchased separately if IAC already has a compliant consent system, but is strongly recommended as a bundled workstream for new exam system deployments.

What COPPA Requires for This System

Requirement	Implementation
Age determination at registration	Date-of-birth capture with age-band classification (Under 13 / 13–17 / 18+)
Verifiable parental consent (Under-13)	Parent email verification + explicit consent capture with timestamped record
Consent versioning	All consent records tied to policy version; re-consent triggered on policy changes
Data minimization	Exam sessions for under-13 students collect only data necessary for scoring; no behavioral tracking
Parental rights portal	Parents can view, download, and request deletion of their child's data
Breach response procedures	Documented internal process; not a software deliverable but required for compliance claim
Audit records	Immutable consent log exportable to CSV for regulatory or legal requests

COPPA Deliverables

1. **Age-Gated Registration Flow** — Date-of-birth capture, age-band routing, under-13 consent gate
2. **Parental Consent Interface** — Email-based consent request, explicit consent form (version-stamped), confirmation email to parent
3. **Consent Record Storage** — Immutable records with: student ID, parent email, consent version, timestamp, IP address, action taken
4. **Consent Receipt Component** — Printable/downloadable receipt for each consent event
5. **Admin COPPA Dashboard** — View consent rates by event, flag missing consents, pull audit reports
6. **Parental Data Rights Portal** — Parent self-service view of stored data; deletion request workflow (admin-reviewed)
7. **Policy Documentation Templates** — Privacy notice template and COPPA disclosure language for IAC's legal review (ScholarArena provides template; IAC legal finalizes)

COPPA Scope Boundary (Critical)

This workstream covers the ScholarArena exam module only. IAC is responsible for ensuring that any other systems handling student data (existing registration tools, email platforms, third-party scoring software) are independently COPPA-compliant. ScholarArena makes no representation regarding IAC's compliance posture outside the ScholarArena platform.

Legal counsel: IAC must engage independent legal counsel to review and approve all COPPA-related policy language, consent text, and data handling procedures. ScholarArena's templates are a starting point, not legal advice.

5. Delivery Timeline

All timelines commence from **Signed SOW + 50% deposit received**.

Week-by-Week Milestone Plan

Week	Milestone	Deliverables	Acceptance Criteria
Week 1	Foundation	Exam data model finalized; question bank authoring UI; COPPA age-gate registration; parent consent flow (email + form)	IAC admin can create a question bank; parent can complete consent flow end-to-end
Week 2	Core Exam Engine	Exam delivery interface; timer + auto-save; anti-cheat controls; COPPA consent records stored; parent data portal (view only)	Student can take a timed exam; consent record created and retrievable
Week 3	Grading & Qualification	Auto-grading; score thresholds; qualification flags; parent result visibility; admin monitoring dashboard	Admin can configure cut-score; student receives pass/fail; parent sees result
Week 4	Integration + Hardening	Regional registration eligibility integration; COPPA audit report; admin COPPA dashboard; security testing; UAT with IAC staff; deployment to production	IAC conducts UAT sign-off; no open P0/P1 bugs; production deployment verified

Post-Launch Hypercare (Weeks 5–6)

- Dedicated Slack channel with ScholarArena engineering on-call
- Same-day response SLA for any exam-day incidents
- One round of minor adjustments (up to 8 engineering hours) at no additional cost
- Handover to standard SaaS support at end of Week 6

6. Pricing & Investment

6.1 Line-Item Breakdown (List Price)

Line Item	Scope	List Price
Exam Module Build	All items in Section 3	\$52,000
COPPA Compliance Workstream	All items in Section 4	\$28,500
Accelerated Delivery Buffer	4-week timeline risk premium (15%)	\$12,075
Hypercare (Weeks 5–6)	Post-launch on-call + 8h adjustment hours	\$5,000
List Price Total		\$97,575

6.2 Founding Partner Pricing

Adjustment	Condition	Amount
Founding Partner Discount	24-month SaaS commitment at standard tier or above	–\$14,625 (15%)

Co-Marketing Credit	IAC agrees to be named as reference customer + 1 case study	-\$2,500
Effective Engagement Total		\$80,450

*Rounded billing figure: **\$80,000** (fixed-fee engagement)*

6.3 Ongoing SaaS Pricing (Post Phase 1)

Platform access fees apply from the month following Phase 1 go-live:

Tier	Annual Participants	Monthly Rate	Founding Partner Lock-In
Growth	Up to 1,000	\$1,200/mo	Locked 24 months
Scale	Up to 5,000	\$2,800/mo	Locked 24 months
Enterprise	Unlimited	Custom	Negotiated at signing

IAC's current scale (150+ regional tournaments, 2,000+ nationals participants) likely places IAC in the **Scale** tier. Rate is locked for 24 months; no mid-contract increases.

6.4 What Is Not Included in SaaS Fees

- Additional phase builds (separate SOW)
- On-site support at national championships (quoted separately, typically \$2,500–\$5,000/event)
- Custom integrations outside the platform (separate SOW)
- Legal or regulatory counsel

7. Commercial Terms

7.1 Payment Schedule

Milestone	% of Engagement Fee	Amount	Trigger
Deposit	40%	\$32,000	Signed SOW
Mid-Point	40%	\$32,000	Week 2 milestone accepted by IAC
Final	20%	\$16,000	Production deployment + UAT sign-off

Payment terms: Net 14 days from invoice. Late payments accrue interest at 1.5%/month.

7.2 Change Order Process

Scope changes requested after SOW signing are subject to a formal Change Order:

1. IAC submits written change request
2. ScholarArena responds with impact assessment (scope, cost, timeline) within 3 business days
3. Both parties sign Change Order addendum before work begins
4. No verbal or email-only change authorizations are binding

Minor clarifications within existing scope do not require a Change Order.

7.3 Intellectual Property

- ScholarArena retains ownership of all platform code, architecture, and proprietary components
- IAC receives a perpetual, non-exclusive license to use the platform during active subscription
- IAC retains ownership of its own data (question banks, student records, competition results)
- Upon subscription termination, IAC data is exportable in CSV/JSON within 30 days; then deleted per retention policy

7.4 Liability

- ScholarArena's total liability under this engagement is capped at the **total fees paid** in the preceding 12 months
- ScholarArena is not liable for IAC's independent COPPA compliance posture outside the ScholarArena platform
- Each party indemnifies the other for claims arising from its own negligence or willful misconduct
- IAC indemnifies ScholarArena for claims arising from IAC's exam content, scoring disputes, or student data it supplies

7.5 Data Processing

A Data Processing Agreement (DPA) covering FERPA, COPPA, and applicable state student privacy laws will be executed concurrently with the SOW. The DPA governs:

- Categories of student data processed
- Sub-processors used by ScholarArena
- Data retention and deletion schedules
- Breach notification obligations (72-hour notice to IAC)
- Jurisdiction-specific requirements (state student privacy laws vary; IAC confirms applicable states)

7.6 Termination

- Either party may terminate for convenience with 30 days written notice
- Work completed and milestones accepted prior to termination are invoiced and due
- Work in progress at termination: ScholarArena invoices for pro-rated hours; IAC receives deliverables completed to date
- Termination for cause (material breach, uncured within 14 days of notice) releases the non-breaching party from further obligation

8. Founding Partner Program

What IAC Gets as a Founding Partner

Benefit	Detail
Product Roadmap Input	Quarterly calls with ScholarArena product team; IAC feature requests receive priority queue placement
Pricing Lock	SaaS tier pricing locked for 24 months from go-live, regardless of general price increases
Dedicated Onboarding	Named Customer Success Manager for first 6 months

Early Access	Beta access to new features (Phase 2 candidate: live scoring, bracket management) before general release
Reference Revenue Share	If IAC refers a paying customer, IAC receives a 10% referral fee on that customer's first-year SaaS contract
Co-Marketing	Mutual announcement; IAC featured in ScholarArena marketing materials (with IAC approval of content)

What ScholarArena Asks of IAC as a Founding Partner

Commitment	Detail
24-Month SaaS Subscription	Minimum Scale tier (\$2,800/mo) for 24 months from go-live
Reference Customer	Agreement to be named publicly as a ScholarArena customer
Case Study	One written case study (co-authored, IAC approval required before publication) within 6 months of go-live
Feedback Participation	Participation in two product feedback sessions per year

9. Assumptions & Exclusions

Assumptions

The pricing and timeline in this proposal are based on the following assumptions. If any assumption proves incorrect, ScholarArena reserves the right to issue a Change Order.

#	Assumption
A1	IAC will provide a dedicated point of contact available for daily async communication during the 4-week build
A2	IAC will provide question bank content (or sample content) by the end of Week 1 for integration testing
A3	IAC will complete UAT within 3 business days of ScholarArena's UAT deployment notification
A4	ScholarArena's current cloud infrastructure (Vercel + managed Postgres) is acceptable to IAC; no on-premise deployment is required
A5	IAC's legal counsel will review and approve COPPA policy text within the 4-week window; delays extend timeline but do not reduce scope
A6	Exam content is English-language only; no translation or localization is required in Phase 1
A7	No custom SSO or identity federation is required; students and parents authenticate via email + password
A8	Maximum concurrent exam-takers per event does not exceed 500 in the first 6 months; capacity planning will be reviewed at Month 4

Exclusions

The following are explicitly excluded and not priced:

Exclusion	Note
Legal advice on COPPA, FERPA, or state privacy laws	IAC must engage independent counsel
Compliance audits or third-party certifications (SOC 2, etc.)	Available as a future engagement
Penetration testing by a third-party firm	Available as an add-on
Training beyond two 1-hour onboarding sessions	Additional sessions at \$250/hour
Data migration from existing IAC systems	Scoped separately if needed
Feature work beyond Phase 1 scope	Requires a new SOW

10. Next Steps

To proceed with this engagement, the following steps are required:

Step	Owner	Target
1. IAC reviews proposal and raises questions	IAC	Within 5 business days
2. Clarification call (if needed)	Both	Within 7 business days
3. ScholarArena issues formal SOW + DPA documents	ScholarArena	Within 2 business days of IAC go-ahead
4. IAC legal reviews SOW + DPA	IAC	Within 7 business days
5. Both parties sign SOW + DPA	Both	Day 0
6. IAC remits 40% deposit (\$32,000)	IAC	Within 3 business days of signing
7. Development begins	ScholarArena	Day 1 (deposit received)

To Accept This Proposal

Email acceptance to: contact@scholararena.com referencing **Proposal SAR-2026-IAC-001**

Or execute the Statement of Work when issued. Proposal is valid for **30 days** from the date above.

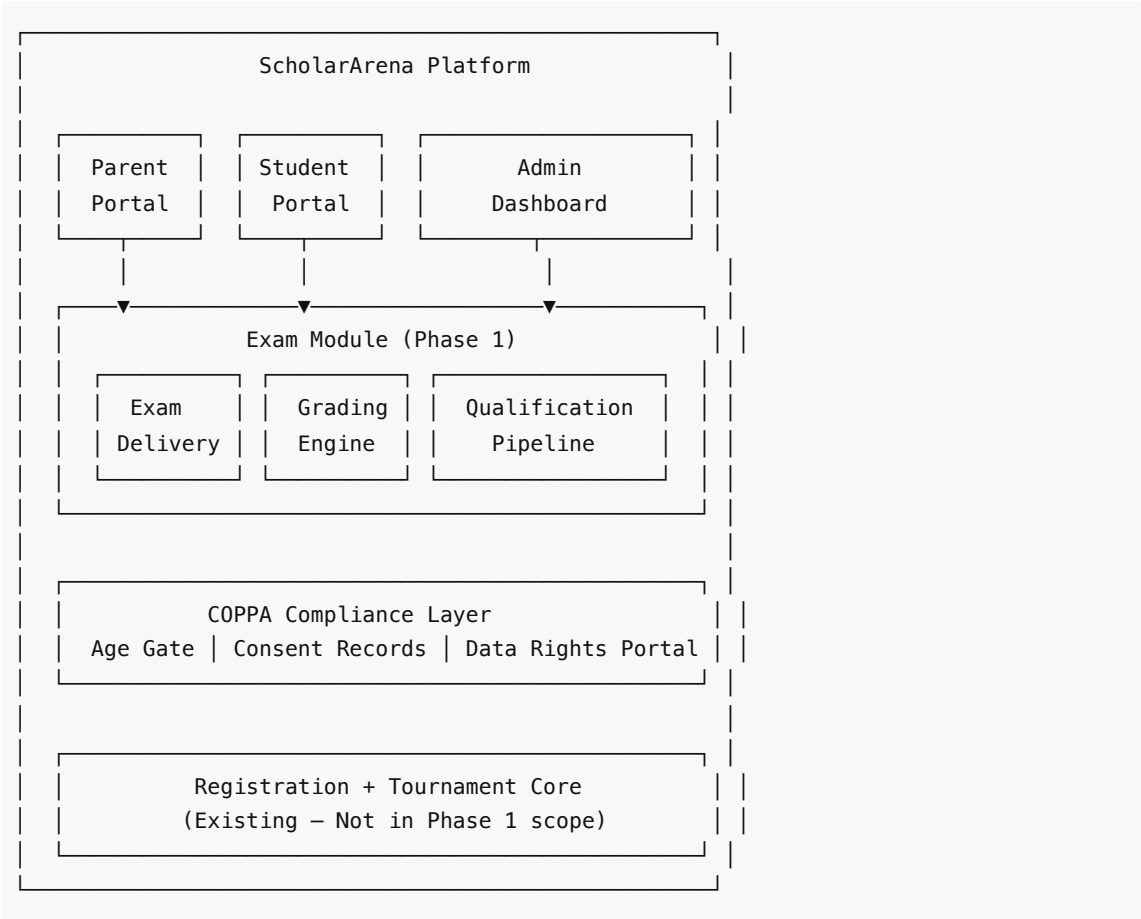
Appendix A: Risk Register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
COPPA legal review delays policy finalization	Medium	Medium	Exam module can go live with consent placeholders; policy text swapped in once approved

IAC UAT feedback requires significant rework	Low	High	Weekly check-ins reduce surprise; Change Order process handles scope additions
IAC content (question banks) delayed	Medium	High	Use ScholarArena sample content for development; swap in IAC content for UAT
Concurrent exam load exceeds infrastructure capacity	Low	High	Load testing in Week 3; auto-scaling configured; IAC provides event schedule in advance
COPPA regulatory change during engagement	Very Low	Medium	All consent logic is versioned; policy version updates are a low-effort swap

Appendix B: Reference Architecture

The exam module will be built as an extension to the existing ScholarArena platform:



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